

Phase 4: The Breeze Parade

Kiosk/startup attractor mode for the Darts & Pats Memory Corridor.

This pass adds **AttractorMode**, a fullscreen idle/startup layer that appears before the threshold and returns after kiosk inactivity. It is intentionally not a new chapter, dashboard, map, or navigation system. It is a living invitation screen for the public touchscreen version of the exhibit.

What Changed

The initial load now opens on **The Breeze Parade**. A large 80px-tall touch button and the parade scene both enter the existing threshold screen. The threshold remains intact behind the attractor layer.

The bottom of the screen uses lightweight CSS shapes for a 2.5D Harrisonburg/JMU-adjacent civic street: storefront silhouettes, crosswalk, newspaper box, bus shape, visitors, and clustered balloons. No WebGL, no sound, no external links, no saved state.

Every 10-20 seconds, one balloon rises and resolves into a clipped newspaper card. The card shows form, year, topic, a short excerpt under 180 characters, and the line “Touch to explore the archive.” Tapping the clipping exits to the threshold, which is the reliable Option A behavior requested for Phase 4.

Attractor Pool

Passive display uses a curated subset of the archive instead of the full 616-record set. Current attractor pool: **72 records**, with **40 Darts** and **32 Pats**. Era balance: **1990s: 16, 2000s: 16, 2010s: 24, 2020s: 16**.

The filter requires a usable kind, year, topic, medium-short text, and enough sentence structure to read as a standalone fragment. It excludes records matching a conservative harsh-language/profanity pattern and avoids very long or very context-dependent entries. This does not remove anything from the Memory Corridor, drawer, Editor Table, or Follow the Strings.

Kiosk Reset

Idle behavior still listens for touchstart, pointerdown, keydown, scroll, and mousemove. After inactivity, the app closes the reading drawer, closes transient trays, clears Class-of/year/topic/kind/search filters, resets Follow the Strings to its default theme, resets the Editor Table card, shows “Returning to The Breeze Parade...”, then activates AttractorMode.

The reset path now guards against cleanup scroll events canceling the return timer. Start Over also returns to The Breeze Parade rather than only to the threshold.

Accessibility And Motion

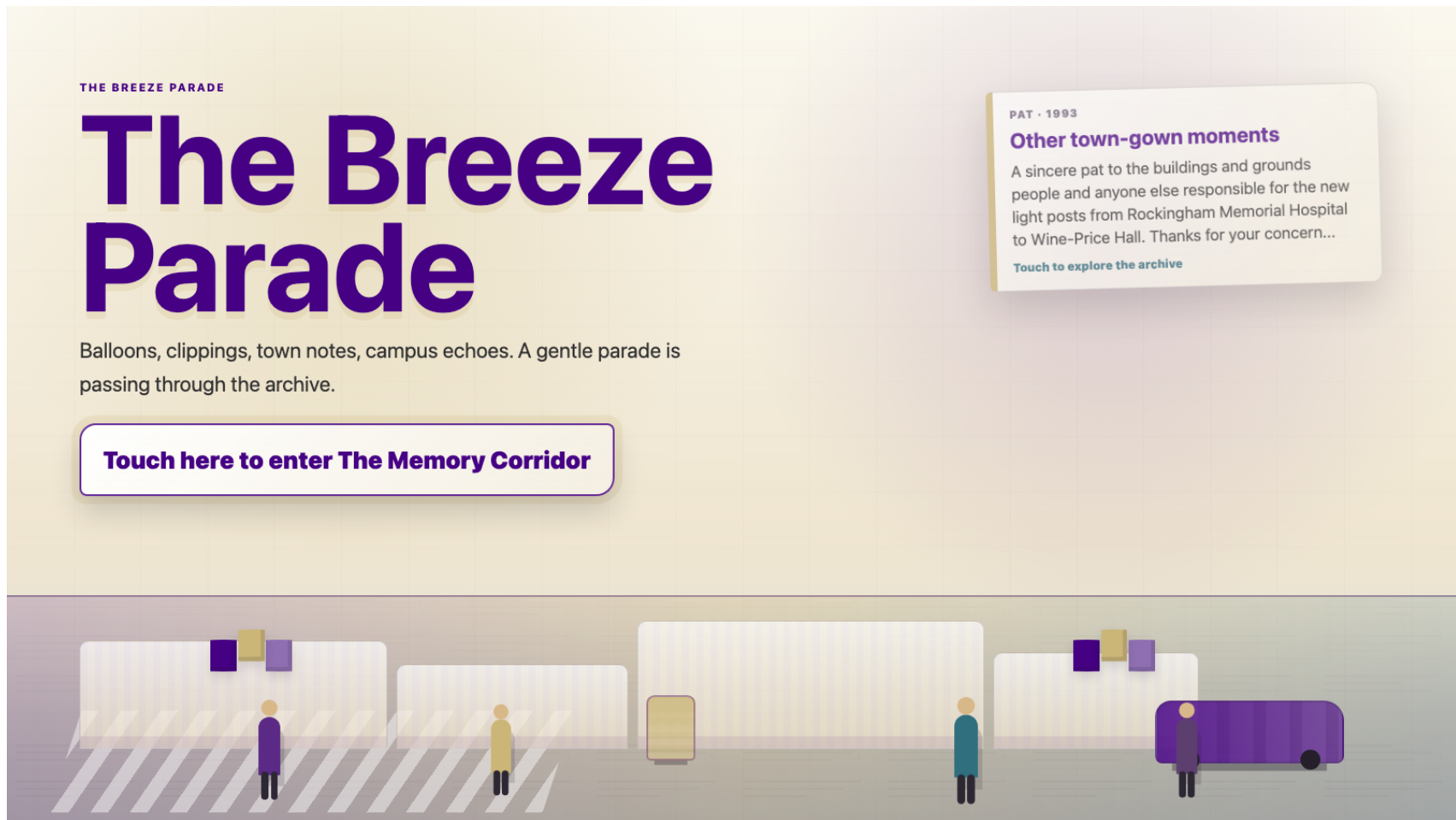
The enter control is keyboard focusable, large enough for kiosk touch, and has visible focus states. The main exhibit is marked inert while AttractorMode is active so keyboard and screen-reader users are not dropped into hidden controls behind the parade.

When prefers-reduced-motion is active, the balloon animation is disabled, the scene remains static, and a clipping card is shown without float/pop motion.

Why It Stays Out Of StoryMap Territory

The attractor is ambient and theatrical, not analytical. It does not add chapter dots, a scrollytelling panel, a map-first layout, or a second navigation scheme. Its job is to invite touch and establish tone: archival, civic, whimsical, warm, and a little tense.

Attractor Mode full idle scene



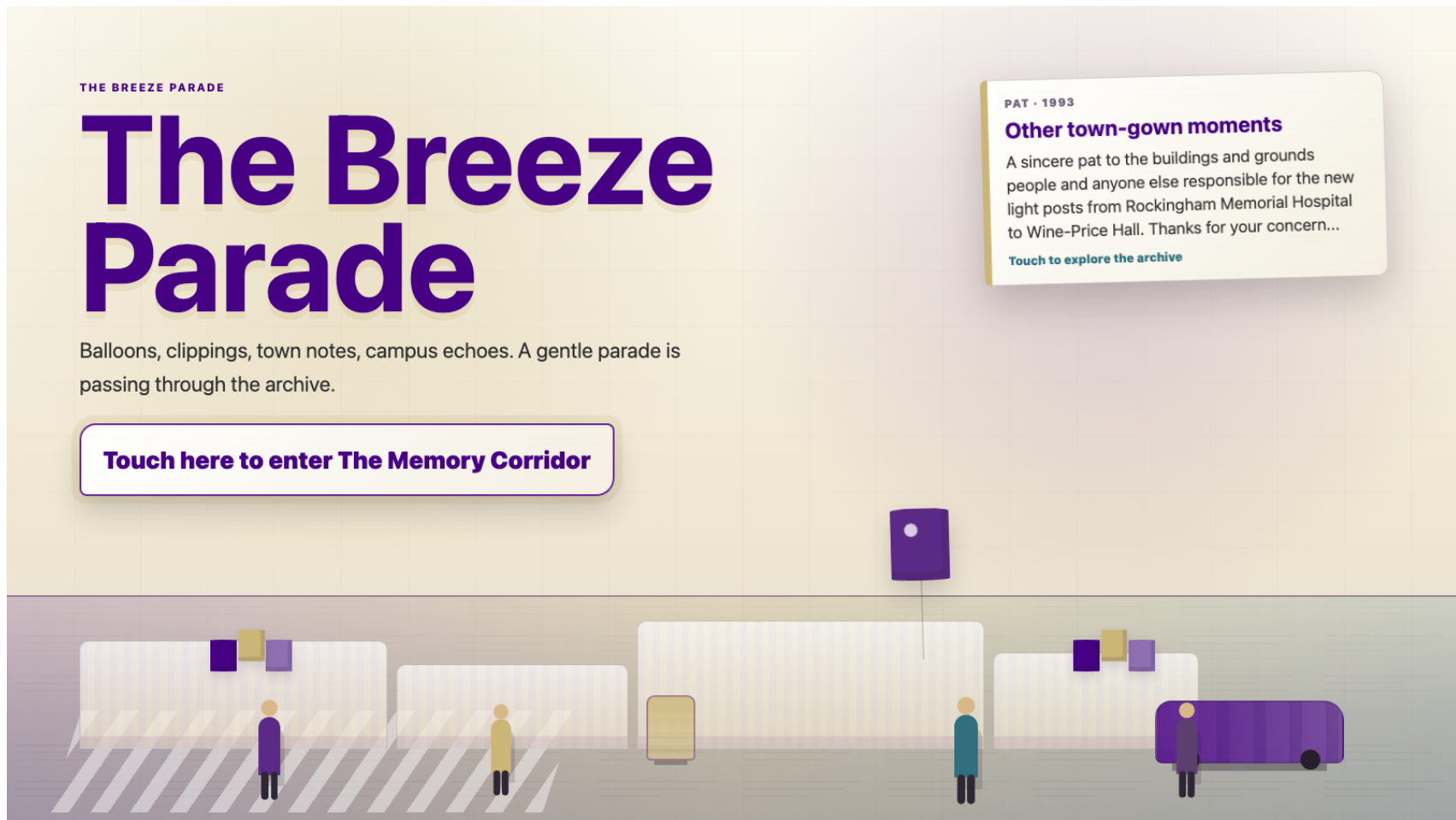
Attractor Mode full idle scene: fullscreen invitation layer before the threshold.

Touch-to-enter button



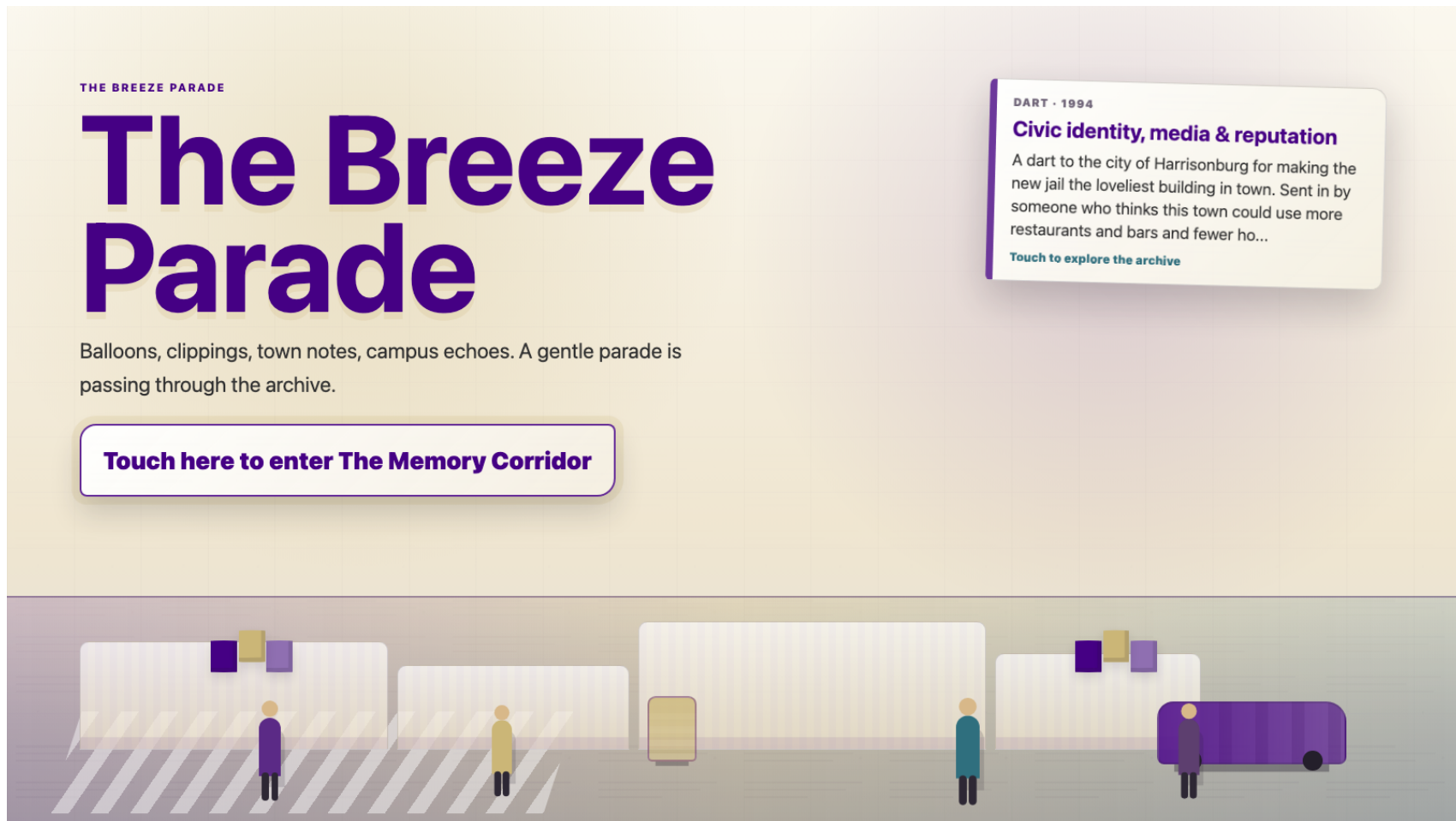
Touch-to-enter button: large kiosk target, 80px tall in the 1600x900 capture.

Balloon rising



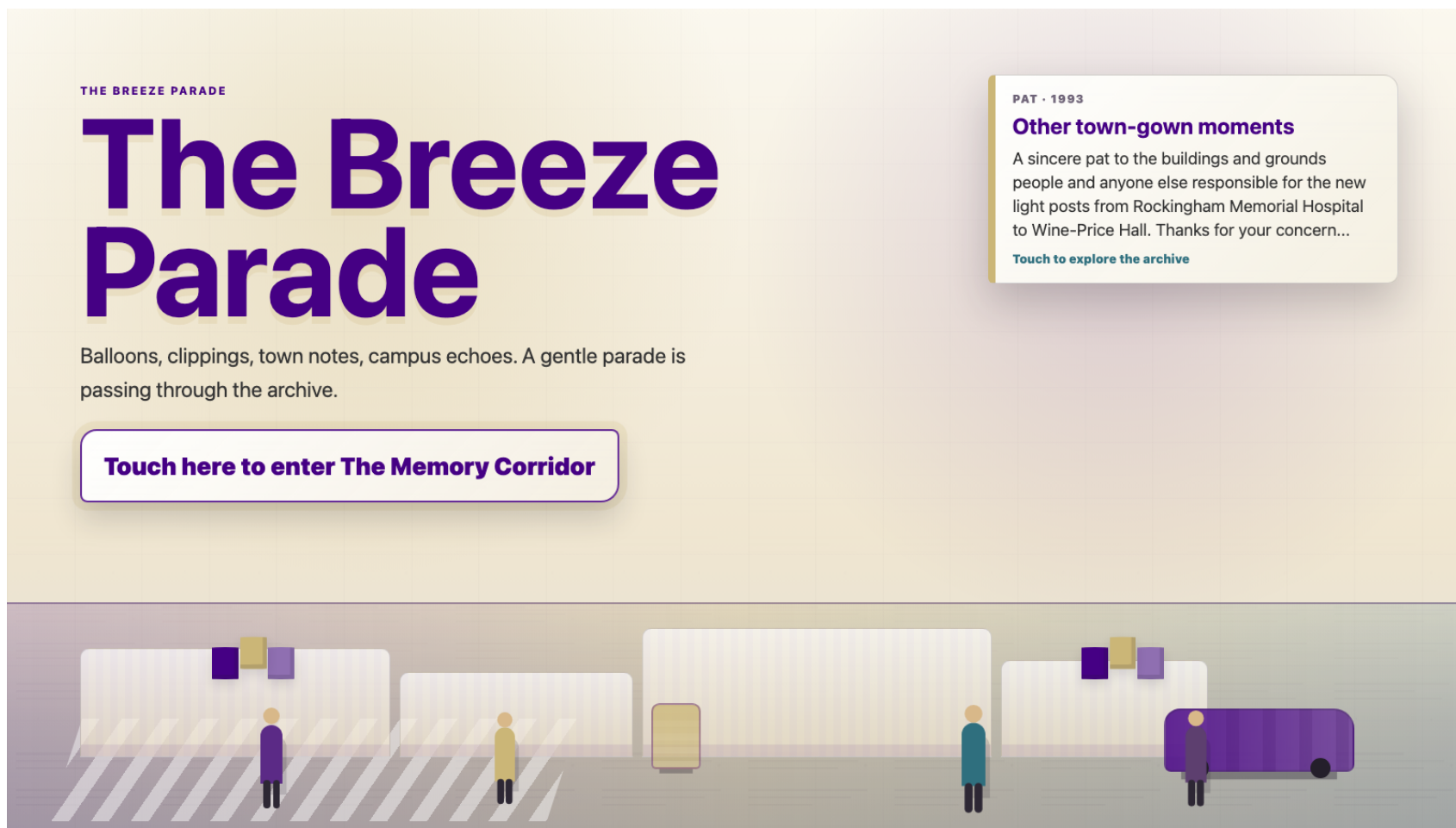
Balloon rising: a single low-overhead CSS balloon detaches from the parade layer.

Popped clipping card



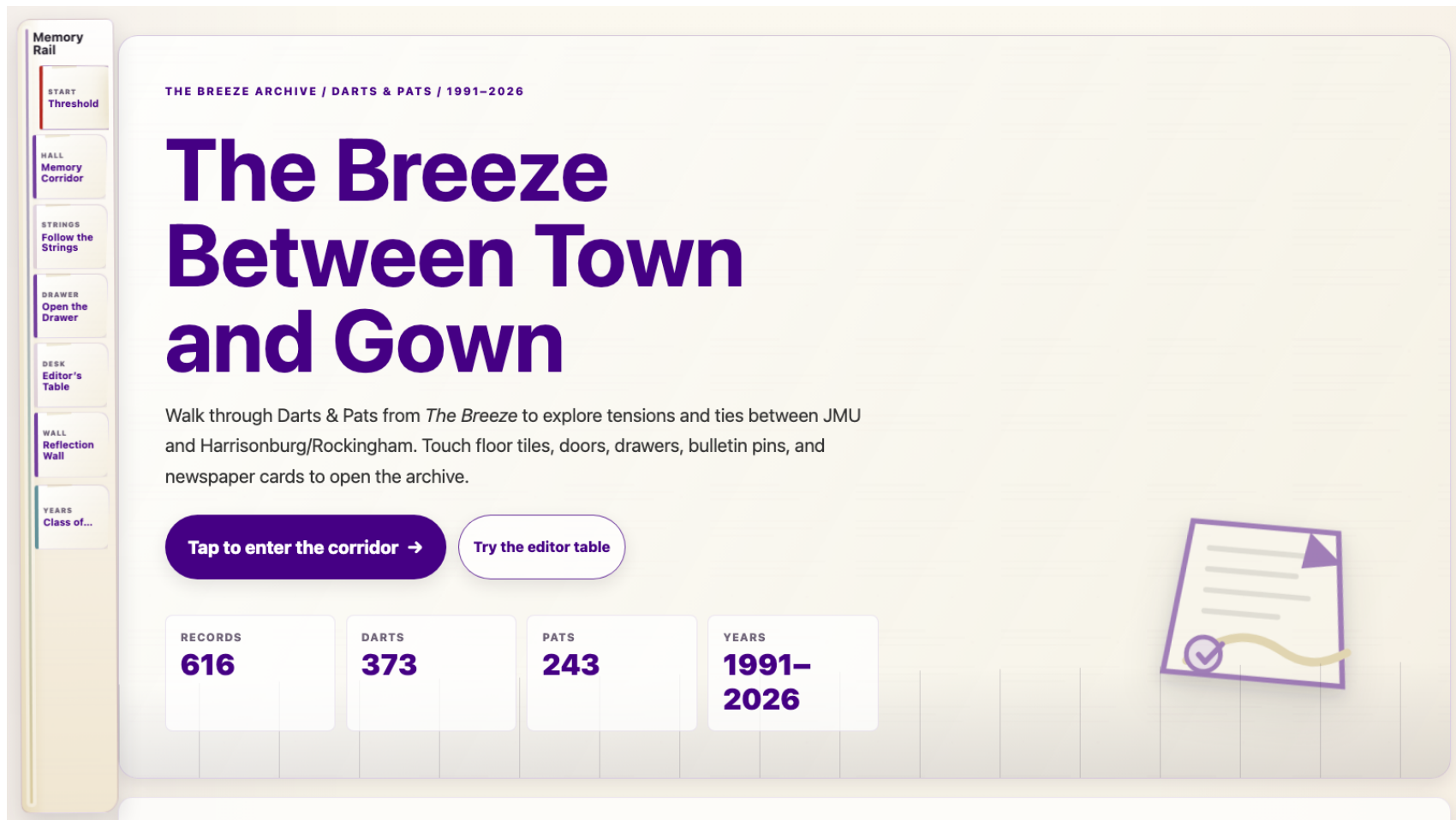
Popped clipping card: a short passive excerpt with form, year, topic, and touch prompt.

Reduced-motion/static state



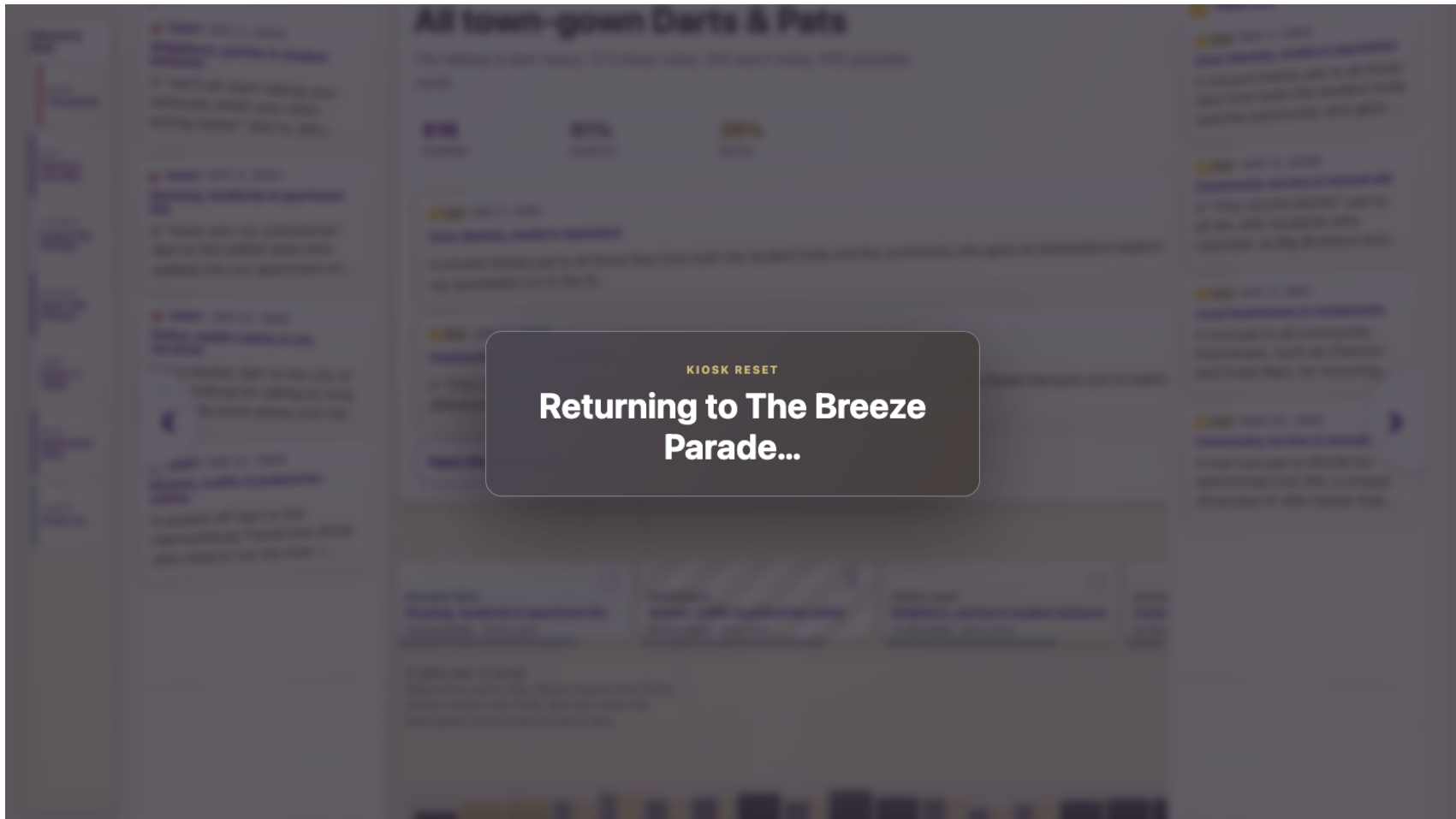
Reduced-motion/static state: no rising balloon, static parade and clipping.

Transition after touch-to-enter



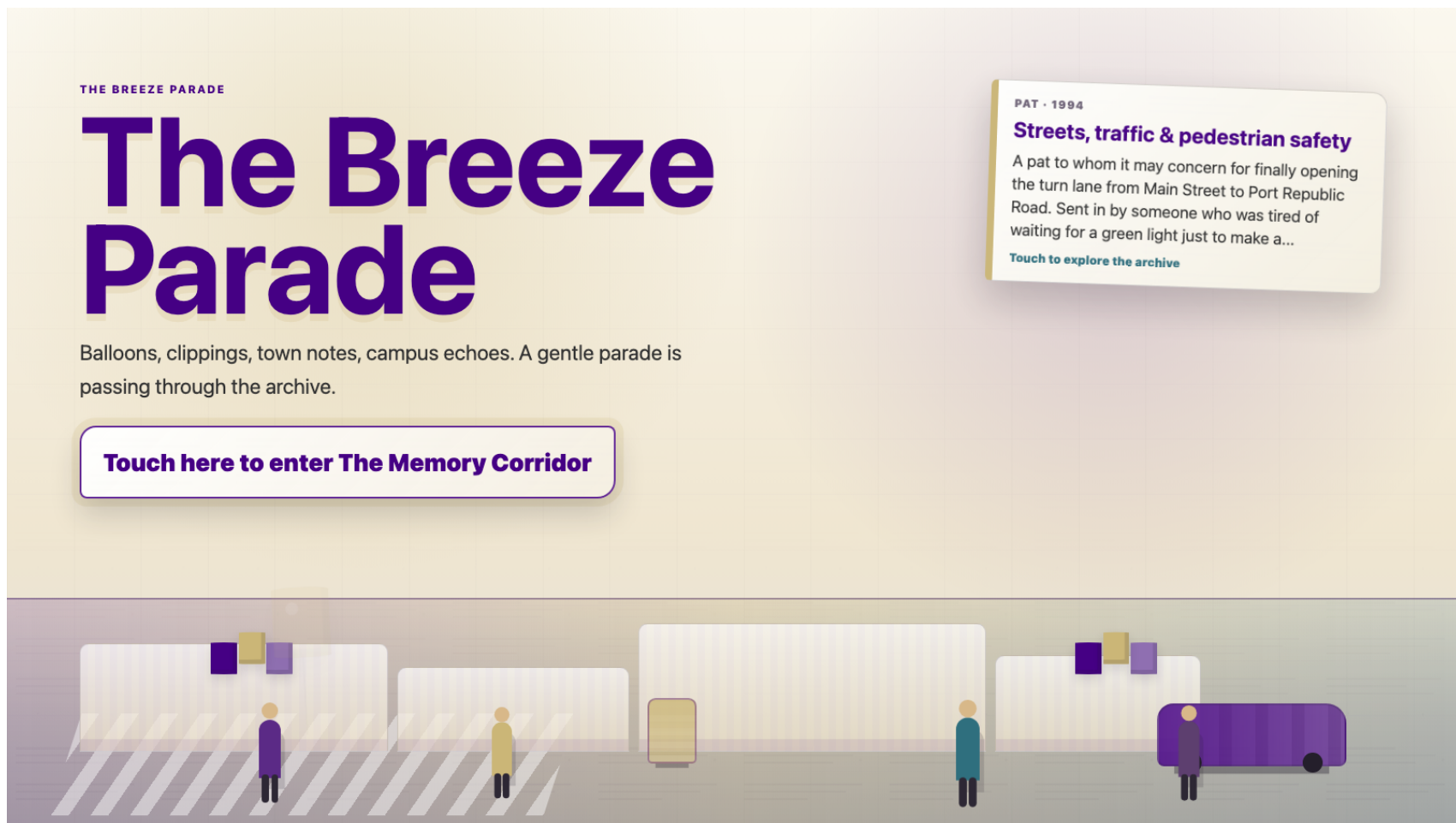
Transition after touch-to-enter: the normal threshold remains the first exhibit screen.

Idle reset overlay



Idle reset overlay: brief message before returning to the attractor layer.

Idle reset returned



Idle reset returned: drawer/filters cleared and The Breeze Parade active again.